

Interview Guide For Hiring Architects

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Introduction

This guide is intended to support lead architects, hiring managers, and talent professionals in their efforts to identify and evaluate candidates for architecture positions. The competencies evaluated here are the same competencies that are used in CEB's Enterprise Architect Effectiveness Diagnostic (EAED). Please note that the EAED is intended to be a comprehensive assessment of architecture teams and new hiring should thus seek to address the greatest talent gaps that exist within teams, rather than advocating for the hiring of "ideal architects." Few, if any, individual architects will demonstrate maturity across all these competencies. We advocate for a portfolio approach to talent management, wherein the members of the team bring their unique profiles to bear to collectively accomplish the architecture mandate of the enterprise.

Using this Guide:

This guide includes 26 competencies in 5 categories and outlines 5 levels of maturity for each. For each new hire, determine which competencies are baseline requirements and establish a minimum level of maturity for these competencies. As candidates are evaluated, using the maturity levels will provide a consistent assessment that can be used to structure the hiring process.

You may find that there are other factors that are important to the success of architects in your organization, such as cultural fit or industry knowledge. We suggest that you use the categories we have outlined (Engagement Skills, Strategic Thinking, Business Understanding, Technical Mastery, and Architecture Work), but make modifications within the individual criteria to account for your organization's circumstances.

The body of this guide provides behavioral and resume-based questions aligned with EAED's architectural competencies, but the Council recommends that you also consider a case-based interview and guidance for case interviewing is provided in the appendix.

The guide aims to test candidates using three question types –

1. Behavioral – These questions are designed to test candidates for specific competencies, based on their past experiences and the way they reacted to specific situations in the past.
2. Resume – These questions help gain an understanding of the candidate's background, in terms of what s/he has achieved so far in terms of responsibilities and execution capabilities, and other qualifications.

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3. Opinion – These questions present various situations to the candidate and ask for how they would react to specific situations in the future or try and gauge their understanding about specific competencies and what it entails to be competent at it.

There are five stages of behavioral interviewing:

1. Situation articulation – The candidate should be able to express the situation, and focus on what wasn't working well in the scenario to warrant change.
2. Candidate's role – The candidate should elaborate on the specific action steps that s/he took to address the situation.
3. Results – The candidate should be able to link his/her specific action steps with the outcome(s).
4. Reflections – The candidate should be able to express what lessons s/he was able to glean from the experience.
5. Takeaways – The candidate should detail what s/he learnt from the entire experience and how s/he will use that experience to act differently in a similar scenario in the future, and why.

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Engagement Skills

Influencing: The ability to persuade others through instruction, dialogue, argumentation, and inspiration rather than through direct authority.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate develops and maintains a vision for work that they alone believe in. LEVEL 2: The candidate is able to persuade peers within his/her area through established relationships. They reach out to individuals who may be impacted by decisions to explain the chosen approach. LEVEL 3: The candidate is able to persuade peers and leaders within his/her area. They build credibility for an initiative by presenting evidence and ensuring that individuals affected by his/her decisions are included in the process at the outset. LEVEL 4: The candidate is able to persuade peers and leaders within and outside his/her area. Candidate has an established track record of being able to articulate and build support for a variety of initiatives. When faced with conflict, the candidate is able to pursue his/her vision without marginalizing others. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in influencing others and is sought out to negotiate support for difficult decisions. S/he can anticipate problems and ensure that credibility and trust are uncompromised. When faced with opposition, the candidate is regularly able to bring others around to his/her point of view.	1. Describe a situation in which you were able to use persuasion to successfully convince someone to see things your way. How were you able to maintain others' confidence? 2. Can you tell me about a time when you affected a key decision on a project? How did you bring people around to your point of view? How did you deal with disagreements? 3. Describe a time when you needed to get help from various people on a project and how you approached those individuals. 4. Think of a situation where you were able to create support for your ideas.	• S/he should be able to describe a purposeful and principled example of influence with as broad an audience as possible. • Candidate's answer should indicate that s/he understands his/her skill set well and can explain how his/her specific skills/contribution led to a particular outcome. • The candidate understands his/her key stakeholders beyond title or seniority. • The candidate values working relationships and is neither too aggressive nor too passive in team situations. • The candidate followed his/her plan or idea with conviction while making difficult decisions. • Managed discussions positively and with maturity and used logical arguments to persuade and negotiate with others.	

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Communication: The ability to convey complex issues to diverse audiences, orally and in writing, in a manner that is easily understood and actionable.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: Peers and others outside the architecture group have trouble understanding the candidate's work. LEVEL 2: The candidate can describe his/her work to peers but others outside their group have trouble understanding him/her. LEVEL 3: The candidate can describe his/her work to a variety of audiences: peers, supervisors, and those outside the immediate group. S/he tailors methods of communication to meet the needs of the particular audience. LEVEL 4: The candidate occasionally leads presentations for the organization. S/he has mastered the ability to present clearly and effectively to diverse audiences orally and in writing. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in communication. S/he is able to bring clarity and understanding to even the most complex topics in a way that leads to actionable outcomes.	1. Describe a situation in which you had to collect information from several people. How did you organize and filter the information you collected? 2. Give an example of a time when you had to engage in a conversation with a diverse audience. 3. Tell me about a time when you had to make a presentation to senior stakeholders. How did you go about presenting and convincing them about your ideas?	• Candidate should provide examples that display an ability to both receive and relay information effectively with various levels of staff. • Candidate should have confidence in their oral and written communication skills indicated by the ability to effectively describe aspects of a project or process, especially in instances where the information was complex. • Demonstrates ability to understand issues and concerns of various stakeholders and project teams. • Shows ability to step into team settings and resolve conflicts rationally and effectively. • Demonstrates the ability to build relationships with people at various levels and teams, both internal and external to the organization.	

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Collaboration: The act by which people come together, regardless of location, to create new value for the organization by working together.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has few opportunities to work with others, and spends most of his/her time working individually. LEVEL 2: When working with others, the candidate focuses primarily on completing his/her individual tasks. LEVEL 3: When working with others, the candidate communicates clear milestones, goals, and deliverables. S/he ensures that everyone on the team understands what contributions others make toward the end goal. LEVEL 4: The candidate occasionally leads collaborative efforts. The candidate understands and capitalizes on the talents of others to drive toward clearly established goals. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in collaboration. The candidate's approaches to collaboration are considered innovative and have been adopted by others in the organization. The collaborative initiatives that the candidate has worked on have delivered substantial value to the organization.	1. Describe a situation in which you worked with geographically or functionally disparate groups of people on a project. How did you align the team's efforts with the overall objectives? 2. Give an example of when you had to work in a team setting and compromise on independent needs to ensure successful project delivery. What role did you play in this? 3. Give an example of a time you had to approach a member of another team or function within your company for assistance on a project. How did you go about making the request? 4. Describe a situation where you had to resolve a conflict. How did you go about doing so?	• Candidate understands and is comfortable with the natural tension between the needs of different constituents within groups of people who come together to accomplish a certain task. • Able to articulate what and how the other team members contributed, and how they worked together and successfully completed the project. • Shows the ability to optimize for the needs of individuals within the group to ensure that all needs are considered, if not met.	

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Leadership: The ability to set strategy, make decisions, and serve as a champion of initiatives that others are willing to support.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate is an individual contributor who owns assigned tasks. LEVEL 2: Candidate occasionally leads some portion of initiatives for which s/he is usually able to gain support. LEVEL 3: The candidate regularly leads some portion of an initiative and occasionally leads entire initiatives in which they set goals, a strategic vision, and lead others in their work. The candidate is building an internal network and can identify and help promote others who they believe are likely to lead in their respective areas. LEVEL 4: The candidate regularly leads large initiatives in the organization. The candidate provides substantive guidance to other leaders on initiatives they own. The candidate has built relationships with others in the organization to foster a strong internal network. The candidate is tasked with building components of a strategic vision for the organization and they advocate for high performers they work with. LEVEL 5: The candidate is sought out as a leader of the most important initiatives in the organization. The candidate is recognized for his/her ability to develop and the leadership skills of others. The candidate has strong relationships with other leaders. The initiatives the candidate has led are considered innovative and regularly achieve their goals with broad support.	1. What would your peers or team say about your leadership style? Can you cite some examples from your experiences? 2. Give me an example of a time when you felt you led by example. Were you assertive? How did others react? 3. Give me an example of when you had to gain support for an unpopular decision. How did you go about implementing it and how did your team react? How did you manage to convince your team to work on it? 4. Give me 2-3 techniques that you've used to motivate your team members. What do you think works best? 5. Describe a project where you played a leadership role. How did you lead that effort and how did people respond to your management style?	• Candidate should show the ability to mentor, coach, and lead others. S/he should also have the ability to develop leadership skills in others. • Understands that different team members have different skill sets, and development needs, and is able to balance that with overall work requirements. • Is able to step in and take charge of situations, especially when team members disagree on something and make sure that the work is not impacted. • Does the leadership style of the candidate match the organizational culture? • The candidate mentions cultivating and employing relationships with other leaders from the organization.	

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Creativity: The ability to bring new and innovative ideas to your work.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate primarily relies on established practices to drive their approaches to current activities. LEVEL 2: The candidate occasionally approaches others outside their immediate group to learn about other approaches to problems and sometimes draw from those ideas to inform their own work. LEVEL 3: The candidate routinely studies work from other fields and looks for ideas that s/he can apply to his/her own work. The candidate regularly adopts new methods and approaches to their current activities. LEVEL 4: The candidate regularly questions current assumptions and pushes the boundaries of thinking to seek out-of-the-box solutions to challenges. The candidate actively prepares for these shifts and shares their thoughts with others within the organization. LEVEL 5: The candidate is recognized for creativity in the organization and is actively sought out by others for innovative ideas on a range of subjects. The candidate has come up with ideas that have been widely adopted and have positively impacted the organization in significant ways.	1. Give an example of an innovative idea that you used to overcome an obstacle you faced in completing a project. How did the idea differ from the norm? 2. Recall a time when you were involved in a brainstorming session. How did you contribute? What worked and what didn't? 3. What sources do you refer to when in need of new ideas or ways of achieving objectives or executing projects? 4. What inspires you?	• Candidate's response should show they are willing to discuss innovative solutions to extraordinary challenges. Their examples should contain examples of unique work processes that were developed or employed to overcome problems. • Candidate has come up with ideas that have positively impacted the larger organization and have been widely adopted. • Should exude curiosity and cite instances where he/she observed processes/ideas from other teams and adapted and implemented them for his/her team. • Does not hesitate to import ideas from other places and customize them for the task at hand. • Demonstrates unconventional points of view.	

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Coaching and Mentoring: The informal development of employees to create an environment that drives toward high levels of engagement, personal performance, and outcome attainment.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate is focused on his/her personal development and does not coach or mentor others. LEVEL 2: The candidate informally coaches and mentors others on an ad hoc basis. LEVEL 3: The candidate coaches and mentors others on a regular basis and consistently helps them resolve problems at work. LEVEL 4: The candidate is sought out by others in the organization to serve as a coach or mentor. S/he has contributed to the improvement of the organization's approach to coaching and mentoring. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in coaching and mentoring. His/her approaches to coaching and mentoring are considered innovative and have been adopted by others in the organization. The individuals s/he has coached and mentored experience significant improvements in their personal engagement and performance.	1. Tell me about a time when you identified a training need in your organization and how you went about making sure those training needs were met. 2. Describe a situation where you helped an individual or group of people improve their performance. What techniques did you use to achieve that? 3. How do you identify latent talent? 4. Describe your best mentoring experience—whether you were the mentor or the mentee. What did you learn?	• Candidate cites examples of being sought out as a coach or mentor, both by the organization and his/her peers. • Displays the maturity required to assess colleagues for potential talent and provides opportunities to cultivate those skills. • Experiences in coaching and mentoring other individuals whose performance improved as a result of this coaching. • Strong sense of empathy with the ability to motivate/inspire peers to perform better. • Understands the reasoning behind delivering various trainings, is patient, likeable, and approachable.	

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Adaptability: The ability to adjust to new, different, or changing circumstances while still ensuring that the overall objective is achieved.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate approaches his/her initiatives with strict process adherence and little room for variation. LEVEL 2: The candidate approaches his/her tasks systematically to ensure that each initiative in his/her portfolio is followed through to its conclusion. When faced with ambiguity or shifting priorities, the candidate proactively reaches out to the necessary stakeholders to ensure that the existing plan still meets the needs of the customer. LEVEL 3: While the candidate approaches his/her tasks systematically, s/he is able to adjust plans to meet changing requirements from stakeholders. LEVEL 4: The candidate occasionally leads initiatives that have a strong likelihood of change. The candidate has a demonstrated ability to adjust to changing circumstances while still driving toward a clear outcome. LEVEL 5: The candidate is sought out as the leader of initiatives with a high degree of ambiguity and potential for change. The candidate is able to adapt to unpredictable or unexpected events by adjusting his/her plans while still achieving the overall objectives.	1. Describe a situation where the scope of the project changed multiple times. How did you react to that and how was the project ultimately delivered? 2. Give an example of a time your team or organization shifted their goals or resources. What effect did it have on your work? How did you respond? 3. Tell me about a time you faced a change in direction at work. What was it and how did you work around it?	• Candidate's examples show that they are able to absorb new information and situations quickly and with ease. • Demonstrates ability to quickly switch tracks to adapt to changes in in-flight projects. • Candidate is resilient.	

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Strategic Thinking

Big-Picture Thinking: The ability to understand the enterprise-wide implications of day-to-day decisions.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate's positions require that s/he focus on specific tasks with little need to consider the implications of his/her work on broader enterprise goals. LEVEL 2: The candidate can understand the implications of his/her work on the larger enterprise, but s/he has little ability to influence or change the larger enterprise's approach. LEVEL 3: The candidate can identify the implications of his/her work and that of others on the larger enterprise. On occasion, The candidate is called upon to provide a holistic perspective on the implications of specific decisions within the enterprise. LEVEL 4: The candidate is regularly called upon to provide a holistic perspective on the implications of specific decisions from both within and outside the enterprise. S/he is called upon to articulate those tradeoffs and to provide recommendations. LEVEL 5: The candidate is considered a leader in the organization for his/her ability to understand how individual decisions affect the enterprise more broadly. His/her recommendations are frequently adopted.	1. Describe a project that you worked on that had implications for the enterprise. How did you go about planning for it? What was the outcome? 2. How does your current role fit into the bigger picture? 3. Briefly describe your working style. Are you a big-picture or detail-oriented person?	• Candidate conveys the ability to manage the small details of a particular project while keeping track of the overall project. • Can anticipate where issues or "land mines" are located and accordingly adjust plans. • Cites examples of projects where his/her contributions impacted business outcomes and can clearly articulate the connection. • Understands how his/her role fits into the overall organization and can give instances of how decisions/actions impacted the final product/customer. • Candidate recognizes the dependences that exist between decisions and initiatives outside the scope of the current work.	

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Parallel Processing: Ability to take on a wide portfolio of responsibilities while ensuring that each task is accomplished effectively.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate is generally tasked with one initiative at a time. LEVEL 2: The candidate is able to balance short and long-term initiatives at the same time while ensuring that responsibilities are accounted for and that tasks are being completed on time. LEVEL 3: The candidate is frequently sought out to take on multiple initiatives at the same time. S/he is able to achieve a high degree of quality and timeliness on these initiatives. LEVEL 4: The candidate is responsible for several short-term and long-term initiatives at any given time and is frequently sought out in the organization for his/her ability to achieve a high degree of quality and timeliness with the initiatives s/he is managing. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in the organization for their ability to successfully manage simultaneous initiatives. They drive toward the highest standards and delivery times on these initiatives. They are able to successfully anticipate roadblocks and course correct accordingly.	1. Describe a situation where you were working on multiple initiatives at the same time. How did you prioritize the different projects? 2. How do you think through compromises that you need to make when juggling multiple projects? 3. Describe a situation in which you were working on multiple projects for different stakeholders. How did you manage competing expectations? 4. Tell me about a time when you worked on multiple projects with different timeframes and levels of criticality. How did you allocate your time across those projects?	• Candidate cites examples where they've been responsible for multiple initiatives, was able to prioritize and allocate time between them, and execute them while keeping the stakeholders in loop without compromising on quality or deadlines. • Can anticipate where issues or "land mines" are located and accordingly adjust plans. • Candidate understands how to use align and use resources as needed to keep multiple workstreams moving concurrently.	

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Strategic Planning: The periodic resetting of mid- to long-term direction and priorities through the alignment of key initiatives and resources to organizational goals and objectives.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in strategic planning. LEVEL 2: The candidate is a contributor to the strategic planning process. LEVEL 3: The candidate has experience heading at least some portion of the strategic planning effort. LEVEL 4: The candidate occasionally leads strategic planning initiatives. They have contributed to improving the strategic planning process by making it more efficient and repeatable. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in strategic planning. They set expectations for the quality and consistency of timelines, and ensure that those standards are met and improved over time. The strategic plans the candidate has created are considered innovative and regularly meet the goals and objectives set out within them.	1. How does your current or previous job relate to the overall goals of the organization? 2. What should be EA's role in strategic planning? 3. What are the components of an IT strategic plan and how does EA contribute? 4. Describe a situation where you anticipated the future and made changes to current responsibilities/operations to meet future needs. 5. What was the strategic planning process at your last organization? How would you change that and why?	• Candidate understands how the EA group contributes to the strategic planning process and how that impacts and is derived from overall business strategy. • Demonstrates knowledge of the strategic planning process and can clearly articulate how they contributed to that process. • Recognizes potential pitfalls in strategic planning and has a point of view on how to avoid them. • Has created some innovative and new strategic plans that meet their intended objectives.	

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Information Synthesis: The ability to take disconnected ideas, concepts, and perspectives from a variety of sources and assemble an articulate, relevant, and precise point of view.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate draws on previous experience as the basis for his/her points of view (POV). The candidate rarely reaches out to others to gather information. LEVEL 2: The candidate consults with others in his/her area and relies on personal experience to inform POV. LEVEL 3: Within the discipline, the candidate learns what is currently known about a topic and how well it is known to develop a point of view. S/he seeks out information from others in their area and integrates that knowledge to update their points of view. LEVEL 4: Both within and outside the discipline, the candidate is able to consistently understand what is currently known about a topic, how well it is known, and where the gaps are to develop his/her POV. The candidate proactively seeks out a wide range of views on the topic to refine their points of view, which they communicate to key stakeholders. LEVEL 5: The candidate is actively sought out by others for their ability to consume information from disparate sources, detail implications, and develop a comprehensive set of recommendations. S/he is able to effectively communicate this knowledge to diverse stakeholders, including senior leaders, to get buy-in for their recommendations.	1. How do you go about developing a POV on a topic that is new to you? How long do you take to research, what sources do you use, and who do you consult? 2. Describe a time when you were expected to come up with a set of recommendations on a new-to-the-organization idea and present it to senior leaders. How did you go about doing that? 3. Tell me about a situation when your opinion changed over time. 4. Tell me about a time when you had a new-to-world project with no standards, references, or guidance. How did you go about establishing direction for the project?	• Candidate can evolve a point of view over time as s/he assimilates new information • Candidate mentions sources where they check on new trends and have an idea of whom to approach in the organization to find out about new topics. • Demonstrates the ability to convey new information on vague topics to a variety of stakeholders effectively. • Is able to map business needs to technology components and vice versa. • Has worked on projects in the past where it was required to pull in information from various disconnected sources and chart out an action plan based on that. • How did the candidate get informed? Who did they talk to? What adjacencies were levered?	

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Visual Thinking: The ability to clarify, synthesize, and analyze information pictorially to effectively depict logical linkages between interrelated elements in an environment or system.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The work of the candidate does not require visual depictions. LEVEL 2: The candidate can use established visual tools, such as roadmaps, to communicate to others within the group. LEVEL 3: The candidate can present ideas visually using both existing tools and their own visualizations. S/he makes presentations of these ideas to a variety of business and IT audiences to help others understand their work. LEVEL 4: The candidate is frequently called upon to create visual depictions of often complex ideas. S/he is able to establish credibility through visualizations and tell a compelling story to his/her audience. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in the organization for the ability to visually depict information. S/he is able to inform, motivate, and convince the audience of a particular point of view through his/her visualizations.	1. Tell me about a time when you conveyed a complex idea through a graphic or other visual. 2. What kind of experience do you have with modeling and representing visual representations of complex designs?	• Candidate was successfully able to convey complex information through his presentations using visual depictions. • Understands what makes for a good visual depiction and what makes it harder to understand a certain graphic. • Expresses ease and enthusiasm for “whiteboarding” and describes visual thinking/communication in ideation.	

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Roadmapping and Planning: The ability to develop and manage the process of migrating from the current to the target state architecture.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in roadmapping and planning. LEVEL 2: The candidate is a contributor to roadmapping and planning activities. LEVEL 3: The candidate has experience heading at least some portion of a roadmapping and planning effort. LEVEL 4: The candidate occasionally leads roadmapping initiatives. S/he has contributed to improving roadmapping and planning processes by making them more efficient and effective. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in roadmapping and planning. S/he has set expectations for quality, consistency, and delivery and ensures that those standards are met and improved over time. The roadmaps and plans s/he creates are innovative and are used in and help guide both strategic and annual planning processes in the organization.	1. Do you have any experience creating roadmaps? What were the roadmaps intended to plan? 2. How did you contribute to the roadmapping process at your previous organization? 3. What makes a roadmap a good roadmap? What details would you include in it? 4. Can you describe a time when you were responsible for creating a roadmap? How did you maintain it and ensure that it stays relevant?	• Candidate understands the roadmapping process and what steps need to be taken to move from the current state to the target state architecture. • Understands what criteria are required for a good roadmap and the pitfalls involved. • Knows what details need to go into the roadmap including project risks, prioritization, timelines, costs, and success metrics. • Cites examples where s/he was innovative and creative with roadmap creation and it was used to inform the organization's strategic plans.	

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Business Understanding

Business Architecture: The application of architecture principles and techniques to the design of business operations, including business capabilities and the business processes, people, technology, and information that enable them.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in business architecture. LEVEL 2: The candidate has a working knowledge of business architecture and participates in information gathering to support my area's business architecture. LEVEL 3: The candidate contributes to the design, documentation, and analysis of my area's business architecture and provides recommendations to ensure the delivery of an integrated, holistic solution. LEVEL 4: The candidate is an expert and is heavily involved in setting the current and future state business architectures. S/he educates business and IT partners on the business architecture. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader within the organization for the business architecture practice and is sought out by business partners for his/her counsel. S/he is responsible for creating and advancing the business architecture vision and strategy. The business architectures s/he has created have substantially improved business performance in those areas.	1. How does enterprise architecture support the business strategy? 2. How would you differentiate between business processes and capabilities? 3. What are the outcomes of business architecture? Why do it?	• Candidate displays understanding of business architecture concepts and can connect business outcomes/requirements with different projects. • Evaluates the IT portfolio in terms of business capabilities, for rationalization. • Has experience in creating business architectures that have a wide impact on the business performance.	

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Service Architecture: The organization and design of the resources (human, technical and otherwise) that are required for the operation of an IT or business service.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in service architecture. LEVEL 2: The candidate has a working knowledge of IT and/or business services and participates in information gathering to support at least one service. LEVEL 3: The candidate contributes to the design, documentation, and analysis of the service architecture and provides recommendations to ensure the delivery of one or more services. LEVEL 4: The candidate is an expert in and is heavily involved in setting multiple service architectures. S/he educates business and IT partners on the service architecture. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader within the organization for the service architecture practice and is sought out by others for his/her counsel. S/he is responsible for creating and advancing the service architecture vision and strategy. The service architectures s/he has created have substantially improved the services they support.	1. How do you define end-to-end IT services? 2. How do you categorize the end-to-end services in your current/past organization? 3. What process do you follow for designing services at your organization? How do you select and prioritize services? 4. What end-to-end services have you architected or helped to architect?	• Candidate can explain how business capabilities map to end-to-end IT or business services. • Uses a logical way of selecting services and applies the right filters for doing so. • Has experience in creating service architectures or roadmaps that have a wide impact on the services they support.	

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Information Architecture: The definition, design, and delivery of an architecture that improves the attainability and usefulness of information in the enterprise, such that knowledge workers can locate, transform, analyze, and communicate information to support effective decision-making.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in information architecture. LEVEL 2: The candidate has a working knowledge of information architecture and participates in information gathering to support the information architecture. LEVEL 3: The candidate contributes to the design, documentation, and analysis of the information architecture in their area and provides recommendations to ensure the delivery of accurate, timely, and consistent information. LEVEL 4: The candidate is an expert and is heavily involved in setting the current and future state information architectures in his/her area. S/he educates business and IT partners on information architecture. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in the organization for the information architecture practice and is sought out by others for advice. S/he is responsible for creating and advancing the information architecture vision and strategy. S/he has expanded the use and successful delivery of information across the enterprise, resulting in improved decision making.	1. Can you detail the last information-related project you worked on? What was difficult about it? 2. Tell me about a time when you worked on creating the information architecture strategy for your organization. What was the outcome and impact of that? 3. In your experience, what is the best approach for making foundational information management investments? 4. How do you approach data quality and usability? 5. How do you design an information architecture that can anticipate future knowledge worker needs?	• Candidate demonstrates the ability to think in a structured and logical manner. • Has experience in creating the information architecture vision that enabled the organization to take better decisions. • The candidate recognizes information's unique role in an organization and has insight on how to deliver high quality information.	

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Technical Mastery

For competencies under this section, the hiring manager familiar with this position should add questions depending on the specific technologies/processes that this role is required to work with/on.

Integration Architecture: The design of the methods and protocols for communication and interoperability between disparate information systems.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL1: The candidate has no experience or training in integration architecture. LEVEL 2: The candidate has a working knowledge of integration techniques and technologies and participates in information gathering to support his/her area's integration architecture. LEVEL 3: The candidate contributes to the design, documentation, and analysis of the integration architecture to ensure that systems effectively and reliably interoperate. LEVEL 4: The candidate is an expert and is heavily involved in setting the current and future state integration architectures. LEVEL 5: The candidate is recognized as a leader within the organization for the integration architecture practice and is sought out by others for expertise. S/he is responsible for creating and advancing the integration architecture vision and strategy. The integration architectures s/he has created have substantially improved the interoperability between systems.	1. Can you detail the last integration project you worked on? What was difficult about it? 2. Describe your key tenets for successful integration architecture.	• Has experience in creating integration architectures that improves interoperability between systems. • Candidate describes instances where s/he educated business/IT partners on the integration architecture.	

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Application Architecture: The design of the applications that are used across the enterprise such that the overall application portfolio operates in a simplified, scalable, and reliable manner.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in application architecture. LEVEL 2: The candidate has a working knowledge of the enterprise application portfolio in his/her area and participates in information gathering to support the enterprise's application architecture. LEVEL 3: The candidate contributes to the design, documentation, and analysis of the application architecture in his/her area to ensure the application portfolio operates more simply and reliably. LEVEL 4: The candidate is an expert and is heavily involved in setting the current and future state application architecture in his/her area. S/he educates business and IT partners on the application architecture. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader within the organization for the application architecture practice and is sought out by others for his/her counsel. S/he is responsible for creating and advancing the application architecture vision and strategy. The application architectures s/he has created have significantly simplified the application portfolio and improved scalability and reliability.	1. What filters would you look at for simplifying the application portfolio of an organization? 2. Tell me about a time when you worked on the application architecture practice for your organization. What was the outcome and impact of that?	• Has experience in simplifying the application portfolio and instituted measures that improved scalability and reliability. • Candidate describes instances where s/he educated business/IT partners on the application architecture.	

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Technical Architecture: The design and integration of the common foundational technologies that are used across the enterprise, including hardware, middleware, networks, security, and system management software.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in technical architecture. LEVEL 2: The candidate has a working knowledge of infrastructure technologies and participates in information gathering to support their area's technical architecture. LEVEL 3: The candidate contributes to the design, documentation, and analysis of the technical architecture in his/her area to ensure the infrastructure runs efficiently and effectively. LEVEL 4: The candidate is an expert and is heavily involved in setting the current and future technical architecture in their area. S/he educates business and IT partners on the technical architecture. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader within the organization for the technical architecture practice and are sought out by others for his/her counsel. S/he is responsible for creating and advancing the technical architecture vision and strategy. The technical architectures s/he has created have substantially reduced the cost and improved the scalability and reliability of the infrastructure.	1. Tell me about a time when you worked on creating the technical architecture strategy for your organization. What was the outcome and impact of that? 2. What technologies do you have direct experience in? 3. How standardized have your previous technical environments been?	• Has experience in creating technical architectures that led to significant cost reductions and improves scalability and reliability of the infrastructure. • Candidate describes instances where s/he educated business/IT partners on the technical architecture.	

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New Technology Innovation: The ability to assess and introduce for deployment new technology solutions to drive efficiencies or enable business capabilities.	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in new technology innovation. LEVEL 2: The candidate is a contributor to new technology innovation initiatives in the organization. LEVEL 3: The candidate has experience heading a new technology innovation effort. LEVEL 4: The candidate occasionally leads new technology innovation initiatives. S/he has contributed to improving the new technology innovation process by making it more efficient and effective. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in new technology innovation. S/he sets expectations for quality, consistency, and delivery, and ensures that those standards are met and improved over time. His/her approaches to new technology introduction are considered innovative and the technologies s/he has introduced have driven substantial efficiencies and enabled significant business capabilities.	1. Can you detail any new technology that you introduced to your organization? Why did you select that technology and how did you roll it out? 2. Tell me about a time when you developed a new process for introducing innovative technologies to the organization? 3. What are the best sources for technology innovation ideas? What should architecture's role be?	• Has experience in introducing new technologies to the organization that have driven substantial efficiencies and enabled significant business capabilities. • Candidate describes instances where s/he improved the process for requesting and employing new technologies. • Candidate can articulate the value that innovation provides the enterprise, as opposed to innovation for its own sake.	

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Architecture Work

In this section, the maturity levels and kind of questions are consistent across the competencies. A candidate's maturity in these competencies can be best judged based on the experience(s) they've had with that specific work product, making these questions resume-driven. This template is for understanding architecture work and the questions themselves are repetitive and consistent in nature.

Modeling and Design: The ability to make choices and tradeoffs that drive optimal decisions through the depiction of concepts, relationships, constraints, rules, and operations in a given architecture or system.

Technology Portfolio Management: The ability to analyze, document, and plan the complete lifecycle of applications, infrastructure, and data with the greatest functionality and performance at the lowest total cost and complexity.

Project Governance: The ability to review, manage, and ensure the adoption of decisions at the project level that are consistent with enterprise architecture principles, strategies and standards.

Architecture Documentation: The ability to use a range of tools and techniques to clearly, consistently, and concisely capture the key components of an architecture.

EA Functional Management: The ability to plan and manage the operations of one's own EA group, including budgeting, hiring, team development, and performance measurement.

Standard Setting: The ability to define, ensure adherence, and manage exceptions to the prescribed or preferred technology, design, data, and process elements that conform to the organization's architecture principles.

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Maturity Levels	Questions	What to Listen For	Candidate Response
LEVEL 1: The candidate has no experience or training in this work product. LEVEL 2: The candidate is a contributor to this work product. LEVEL 3: The candidate has experience heading some portion of this work product. LEVEL 4: The candidate occasionally leads initiatives for this work product. S/he has contributed to improving the process followed for this work product by making it more efficient and effective. LEVEL 5: The candidate is a recognized leader in this work product. S/he sets expectations for quality, consistency, and delivery, and ensures that those standards are met and improved over time. His/her approaches to this work product are considered innovative and have delivered exceptional performance.	1. What experience do you have with [this work product]? 2. Tell me about a time when you developed a new process for [this work product] at your organization? 3. How was [this work product] managed in your previous organizations? What do you think separates successful practices from unsuccessful ones?	• Has experience in working on initiatives for this work product. • Has improved the existing process for working on this work product. • The candidate understands what separates good practices from mediocre ones for this work product.	

Appendix: Resources and Guidance for Case Interviews

Where to find case interview materials:

There are a lot of books that have examples of good case studies that you can use to test candidates. A number of management consultancy companies and recruitment journals also upload examples of cases on their Web sites to help prospective candidates. The following is a list of the more commonly used books on case interviews -

1. Vault Guide to the Case Interview
2. Case in Point
3. Case Interview Secrets

How to craft a good case interview:

Use cases to test the right competencies rather than targeting them as general behavioral assessments. More important than the actual case selection is what you're trying to evaluate through the case. Case interviews are efficient in evaluating candidates because they help the recruiter achieve 2 objectives –

- Test how the candidate will react to situations that they will regularly experience on a day-to-day basis in that role
- Test the candidate for specific skills that are relatively harder to evaluate through other means such as behavioral or resume-based interviews

To structure a good case interview, employ the following steps –

1. Evaluate the needs of the hiring function, as well as requirements from the business and other stakeholders to decide which competencies to test the candidate for. Balance this need by focusing on skills that are not easy to develop in staff.
2. Use cases that are general and not too specific and also leave room for interpretation to understand the candidate's thought process. Give the candidate time to prepare for the case.

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3. The cases should mirror actual business situations that people in that role will typically face. This should include as many facets of the role as possible, such as asking the candidate to present his/her recommendations to senior leaders who act as business partners/stakeholders.

How to evaluate case interview responses:

Progressive organizations institute a system for evaluating candidates that follow these principles -

1. Refer to a consistent scoring mechanism that defines different proficiency levels for each competency to ensure a standard way of evaluating candidates.
2. Use a consistent set of interviewers to maintain uniformity in the assessments.
3. Instead of looking for the right answer, evaluate the approach the candidate adopts to respond to the case.